

"Remove Task Manager" option in the right side to "Disable" or "Not Configured". Close Gpedit.msc. Then run "gpupdate /force".

The second possibility: the problem could be because of a change in the Registry settings, which can be corrected thus:

Open Regedit.exe, and navigate to and correct the keys as below (you should be Administrator on your machine):

[HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Policies\System]

"DisableTaskMgr"=dword:00000000

[HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Group Policy Objects\LocalUser\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Policies\System]

"DisableTaskMgr"=dword:00000000

[HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\policies\system\]

"DisableTaskMgr"=dword:00000000

[HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows NT\CurrentVersion\Winlogon]
"DisableCAD"=dword:00000000

A Shadowy Presence

Q I have a 256 MB pen drive. When I plug it into a system with Windows XP—it doesn't get detected in other versions—it responds by showing "New hardware found", "Installing device", and "Ready to use". Even in My Computer, the drive appears, but on opening it, it says "Please insert drive". How do I rectify this?

Joel Jose

A It seems that your pen drive is not formatted. Try to format it by opening Windows Explorer, right-clicking on it and selecting Format. If this does not seem to work, try using the HP Disk Storage Format Tool, which can be downloaded from <http://selfdestruct.net/misc/usbboot/SP27213.exe>. If this doesn't work either, your pen drive is probably damaged.

Driving Me Nuts!

Q My system configuration is 1.2 GHz Intel Celeron, 256 MB RAM, 80 GB hard drive with six Windows partition of 10 GB each, and in the rest of the space, I'd installed Red Hat Enterprise Edition. I have dual-booting of Windows—Windows 98 SE on the C: drive and Windows XP on D:. My BenQ CD-Writer connected as secondary master, and Samsung combo drive connected as secondary slave, don't work in Windows XP, but work fine in Windows 98. The icons cannot be seen in My Computer, and when I go to Device Manager, it shows a yellow exclamation mark. I've tried uninstalling and restarting the PC, and also clicking on the option scan for hardware changes.

Manish Gupta

A This problem occurs when the chipset drivers for the motherboard get corrupted. You can go to www.intel.com and download the latest version of chipset drivers for your motherboard and install them. You should be able to access your optical drives on the next boot.

Giving Vista The Boot

Q I installed the beta version of Windows Vista on my computer, dual-booting with Windows XP Professional. How do I it?

Raghu Kolhe

A We're assuming you installed Vista on a separate partition with nothing else on it. Boot into Windows XP. Insert your Vista DVD into the drive, or load the image in DVD emulation software. Run "X:\boot\bootsect.exe /nt52 ALL /force" (where X is your Vista DVD drive letter). Restart the computer and you will find that the old XP boot menu has returned. Format the partition where installed Vista, and remove Boot.BAK and Bootsect.BAK.

Got A Minute... Or More?

Q The default time limit for recording in the Windows Sound Recorder utility is one minute. Is there a way to increase this to, say, 15 minutes?

Kallol Das

A To increase Sound Recorder's time limit, you need to follow this (somewhat tedious) procedure.

Open Sound Recorder and click on the Record button. Let it record for a period of one minute until it stops. Now click on File > Save and save the file as Blank.wav.

Next, click on Edit > Insert File... and insert the blank.wav file you just created. You will see that the recording time limit increases by one minute. In this way, if you wish to increase it to 15 minutes, insert this file 15 times. If you wish to make 15 minutes as the default recording length, do the following: save the file you created in the previous step (this will be a 15-minute blank WAV file). Go to Start > All Programs > Accessories > Entertainment, right-click on Sound Recorder, and click Properties. In the Target box, you will see "%SystemRoot%\system32\sndrec32.exe"; change it to "%SystemRoot%\system32\sndrec32.exe C:\Sound\blank.wav" (without the quotes), assuming you saved the blank.wav file to C:\Sound. When you start Sound Recorder the next time, this file will open automatically. After recording your audio, you can click on Edit > Delete After Current Position to remove the blank space after the recording is done. Don't forget to save this newly-recorded file with a new filename, because if you accidentally overwrite the blank.wav file, the recording limit will become equal to the time for which you just recorded the audio.

This is just a workaround; you can use other utilities such as Nero Wave Editor (bundled with Nero) or Goldwave from www.goldwave.com, for making the task easier—or even WavePad from www.nch.com.au/wavepad. ■

